

AURORA — Phase 1 Technical Findings (DRAFT, Privileged)

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Prepared by / owner	Renata Castellano
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DRAFT — PRIVILEGED & CONFIDENTIAL — PREPARED AT THE DIRECTION OF COUNSEL — ATTORNEY WORK PRODUCT. This memorandum records preliminary, work-in-progress technical findings of the AURORA workstream. It is a draft prepared for the purpose of obtaining legal advice and is not a final conclusion. Findings are subject to revision as the investigation continues.

Workstream	AURORA (Phase 1 technical findings)
Prepared by	Renata Castellano, Engagement Lead, IronLake Forensics
For	Priya Raman, General Counsel (counsel)
Status	DRAFT — privileged — not for distribution
Period under review	October–November 2025

1. Summary of preliminary findings

Forensic review of Kestrel object-store access logs identified **anomalous bulk reads** of the object **legacy_uap_backup_2021.tar.gz** during the period **18-20 October 2025** (earliest activity in the **18 October 2025** window). The access pattern is inconsistent with any scheduled restore or analytics job. On the present evidence, a **bulk export is probable**; the read volume and egress are consistent with retrieval of the object in substantial part.

- 5 distinct anomalous bulk-read events across the window.
- Peak/cumulative egress on the legacy backup prefix of approximately 1,840 GB flagged by detection content.
- Source IPs resolve to 3 foreign autonomous systems (ASNs) not associated with any known restore operation.
- Reads originated from principals/accounts not present in the documented restore schedule.

2. Contents of the affected object

The object **legacy_uap_backup_2021.tar.gz** is a 2021-era backup of the legacy Unified Account Profile store (**legacy_uap**). Based on inventory metadata and sampling, the backup contained approximately **912.8m** historical profile records, of which approximately **286m** correspond to accounts active within the preceding 24 months.

Attribute	Preliminary assessment
Total historical profile records	~912.8m (912,800,000)
Active within 24 months	~286m (286,000,000)
Record fields present	names, usernames, email addresses, recovery email addresses, phone numbers, dates of birth, salted password hashes, password-reset tokens, security-question hashes
Legacy SMB accounts (special concern)	~8.4m legacy small-business accounts with improperly encrypted security-question answers (legacy small-business accounts)
Payment / bank data	No raw payment card numbers or bank account data were contained in the backup.

3. Authentication exposure — cookie-forging feasibility

The VPAuth legacy session-signing key (kid=vpauth-legacy-2019) has **not been rotated since 2019**. Because this long-lived key remains in the legacy validation path, an actor in possession of the key (or of material sufficient to derive valid signatures) could **forge session cookies** accepted by the legacy VPAuth path. Abnormal token-validation patterns observed during the window are consistent with — though not, on present evidence, conclusive of — session forging. We observed on the order of 41,500 suspected forged/replayed session events.

4. Data categories and sensitivity

- Identifiers and contact data: names, usernames, email and recovery-email addresses, phone numbers, dates of birth.
- Authentication material: salted password hashes and password-reset tokens.
- Knowledge-based recovery: security-question hashes; and, for the legacy SMB cohort, ~8.4m records whose security-question answers were **improperly encrypted**.
- No raw payment-card numbers or bank-account data were contained in the backup.

5. Preliminary conclusions (draft — subject to revision)

- 1 Anomalous bulk reads of the legacy_uap backup occurred during 18–20 October 2025.
- 2 On the present evidence, bulk export is probable; scope of any onward use is not yet established.
- 3 The unrotated legacy signing key materially increases authentication risk and should be rotated and retired as a priority.
- 4 Further work is required before any of the above can be stated as a definitive finding.

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